UNIVERSITY OF COLOMBO

FACULTY OF LAW

ENGLISH FOR LAW – II

PORTFOLIO SUBMISSION

Registration Number : 2014L10153

Word Count :

Topics Of Self-reflection Notes And Session Dates :

1. Film Study: 12 Angry Men →Date: 17th February.
2. Essay Writing: One Country, One Law →Date: 21st March.
3. In-Course Assessment: Prevention of Anarchy and Promotion of Public Order Bil →Date: 15th June.
4. Sri Lankan Penal Code Provisions →Date: 12th August.
5. Maxims of Equity Presentation →Date: 8th September.
6. Presentation: Main Parts of a Contract →Date: 23rd October.
7. Film Study: Kramer v. Kramer →Date: 11th November.
8. Divorce Laws – Special Laws →Date: 19th November.
9. Conclusion.
10. Student Declaration.

This portfolio is a collection of my learning activities, assessments, presentations, and reflections completed during the English for Law course. It demonstrates my development in legal English, critical thinking, legal vocabulary, case analysis, and presentation skills. Through essays, film reviews, legal discussions, and presentations, I have improved my ability to understand and communicate legal concepts clearly and confidently.

Film Study: 12 Angry Men at 17th February 2025

We watched the film 12 Angry Men and answered several questions based on it. The film focuses on jury deliberation, reasonable doubt, prejudice, and justice.

What I Learned

This activity helped me understand important legal concepts such as presumption of innocence, burden of proof, and reasonable doubt. I also learned how personal bias and assumptions can affect legal decision-making. From a language perspective, I improved my listening skills and learned legal and courtroom-related vocabulary.

Reflection

This lesson showed me the importance of critical thinking in law. It also helped me express opinions and arguments clearly in English, which is essential for a law student.

Essay Writing: One Country, One Law at 21st March 2025

I wrote an essay on the topic One Country, One Law. The essay discussed the idea of having a uniform legal system and its possible impact on society.

What I Learned

Through this essay, I developed my academic writing skills, including structuring an essay, using formal English, and presenting balanced arguments. I also learned how to express legal opinions clearly and logically.

Reflection

This activity helped me improve my confidence in legal writing and strengthened my ability to discuss sensitive legal and social issues using appropriate language.

In-Course Assessment: Prevention of Anarchy and Promotion of Public Order Bill at 15th June 2025

This in-course assessment required me to discuss the Prevention of Anarchy and Promotion of Public Order Bill with reference to decided cases and to analyze the constitutionality of three provisions of the bill.

What I Learned

I learned how to analyze legislation, refer to case law, and discuss constitutional issues using proper legal terminology. This task also improved my ability to answer problem-style legal questions in English.

Reflection

This assessment enhanced my analytical skills and helped me understand how English is used in constitutional and statutory interpretation.

Sri Lankan Penal Code Provisions at 12th august 2025

We discussed several provisions of the Sri Lankan Penal Code, including Sections 148, 162, 191, 205, and 279.

What I Learned

This lesson helped me understand the structure of Penal Code provisions and how offences are defined. I also learned important criminal law vocabulary and how to explain legal provisions in clear English.

Reflection

This discussion improved my ability to read and interpret statutory language and explain legal concepts accurately.

Maxims of Equity Presentation at 8th September 2025

I presented on the maxim “Equality is Equity.”

What I Learned

Through this presentation, I learned how equitable principles aim to ensure fairness and justice. I also developed my public speaking skills and learned how to explain legal maxims in simple English.

Reflection

This presentation improved my confidence in speaking English in front of an audience and strengthened my understanding of equity in law.

Presentation: Main Parts of a Contract at 23rd October

I gave a presentation on the main parts of a contract, including offer, acceptance, consideration, intention to create legal relations, and capacity.

What I Learned

This lesson improved my understanding of contract law terminology and structure. It also enhanced my ability to explain legal concepts clearly and logically in English.

Reflection

This activity helped me connect legal knowledge with effective communication skills, which are essential for future legal practice.

Film Study: Kramer v. Kramer 11th November 2025

We watched the film Kramer v. Kramer and answered questions related to divorce and child custody.

What I Learned

I learned about family law concepts such as custody, parental responsibility, and the emotional impact of divorce. This activity also improved my comprehension and legal discussion skills in English.

Reflection

The film helped me understand how legal issues affect real lives and strengthened my ability to discuss family law matters sensitively and clearly.

8. Divorce Laws – Special Laws

Date: 19th NovActivity November 2025

I answered questions related to divorce under special laws in Sri Lanka.

What I Learned

This lesson helped me understand different divorce laws applicable to various communities in Sri Lanka and the importance of using precise legal language.

Reflection

This activity enhanced my comparative understanding of family law and improved my ability to answer structured legal questions in English.

Conclusion

This portfolio reflects my progress in the English for Law course. Through essays, films, assessments, and presentations, I have developed my legal English skills, critical thinking, and confidence in using English in a legal context context.

Student Declaration

I hereby declare that this portfolio is my own work and has been prepared for the purpose of fulfilling the requirements of the English for Law course. All information included is true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

Support materials for Discussed divorce under special laws in srilanka 18th November 2025



HEINONLINE

DATE DOWNLOADED: Fri Sep 20 06:57:22 2024
SOURCE: Content Downloaded from HeinOnline

Citations:
Please note: citations are provided as a general guideline. Users should consult their preferred citation format's style manual for proper citation formatting.

Bluebook 21st ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience, 1996 INT'l SURV. FAM. L. 461 (1996).

ALWD 7th ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience, 1996 Int'l Surv. Fam. L. 461 (1996).

APA 7th ed.
Goonesekere, Savitri W.E. (1996). Family Law in Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience. International Survey of Family Law, 1996, 461-480.

Chicago 17th ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, "Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience," International Survey of Family Law 1996 (1996): 461-480

McGill Guide 9th ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, "Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience" [1996] 1996 Int'l Surv Fam L 461.

AGLC 4th ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, 'Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience' [1996] 1996 International Survey of Family Law 461

MLA 9th ed.
Goonesekere, Savitri W.E. "Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience." International Survey of Family Law, 1996, 1996, pp. 461-480. HeinOnline.

OSCOLA 4th ed.
Savitri W.E. Goonesekere, 'Family Law in a Multi Cultural Society with Plural Legal Traditions: The Sri Lanka Experience' (1996) 1996 Int'l Surv Fam L 461
Please note: citations are provided as a general guideline. Users should consult their preferred citation format's style manual for proper citation formatting.

-- Your use of this HeinOnline PDF indicates your acceptance of HeinOnline's Terms and Conditions of the license agreement available at https://heinonline.org/HOL/License
-- The search text of this PDF is generated from uncorrected OCR text.

SRI LANKA

FAMILY LAW IN A MULTI CULTURAL SOCIETY
WITH PLURAL LEGAL TRADITIONS:
THE SRI LANKA EXPERIENCE

Savitri W.E. Goonesekere*

I INTRODUCTION

Several Asian and African countries that were originally British colonies with a Common Law legal heritage embarked on a restatement or codification of some aspects of their family law after gaining independence. For instance, India, Malaysia, Singapore, Nigeria and Ghana have given priority to reform or codification of Family Law in the post independence period.[1] By contrast, Sri Lanka's family laws on marriage, family support, matrimonial property and inheritance are in general derived from provisions in nineteenth century colonial legislation. Two statutes on marriage and divorce applicable to a religious and regional minority community were enacted after independence.[2] However, a comprehensive report on reform of the Marriage and Divorce laws of Sri Lanka, submitted in 1959[3] has not been considered by successive governments for the purpose of introducing reforms. Family law reform has therefore been a low priority for governments in the post independence period.

Concern with gender equality and children's rights in the last decade has led to the adoption of two policy documents, the Children's Charter (1992) and

* Attorney at Law, Professor of Law, University of Colombo.

1 Codification of Hindu family laws, as discussed in B N Sampath "India" in Law Asia Family Law Series Vol II (Singapore: LAWASIA 1981) 1; Women's Charter Singapore (1961); Law Reform (Marriage and Divorce) Act Malaysia (1976); Matrimonial Causes Act Ghana (1971); Matrimonial Causes Decree Nigeria (1970).

2 Muslim Marriage and Divorce Act (1951), Kandyan Marriage and Divorce Act (1952).

3 Report of Commission on Marriage and Divorce. Sessional Paper XVI of 1959.

A. Bainham (ed.), The International Survey of Family Law 1996, 461-479.
© 1998 The International Society of Family Law, Printed in The Netherlands.

Supporting materials for 11th November 2025

English for Law – II

Divorce Module – Assignment

Movie Screening - *Kramer vs. Kramer*

Areas: Divorce and Custody of the Minors

Instructions

Watch the Movie and answer the following questions

Type of Assignment: Individual Take-home Assignment

Marks: 20 Marks (5 Marks x 4 Questions)

Questions

1. What legal conflicts are presented in this film?

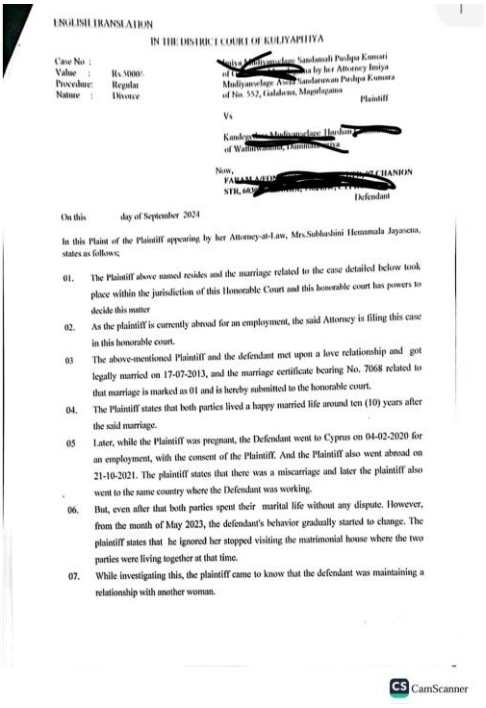
2. In what ways does the film illustrate the effects of parental divorce on their children?

3. How does the movie convey the social and emotional effects of divorce on spouses?

4. Do you believe that single parenting poses challenges? If so, what are they?



Support materials for 4th november



ENGLISH TRANSLATION

IN THE DISTRICT COURT OF KULIYAPITIYA

Case No :
Value : Rs.5000/-
Procedure: Regular
Nature : Divorce

[redacted] represented by her Attorney Imiya Mudiyanselage Ariyarathna Sandaruwan Pushpa Kumara of No. 552, Gidabena, Magulagama
Plaintiff

Vs

Kandegedara Mudiyanselage Hashan [redacted]
of Wathuwatta, Dummalasuriya

Now,
[redacted]
Defendant

On this day of September 2024

In this Plaint of the Plaintiff appearing by her Attorney-at-Law, Mrs.Subhashini Hemamala Jayasena, states as follows;

01. The Plaintiff above named resides and the marriage related to the case detailed below took place within the jurisdiction of this Honorable Court and this honorable court has powers to decide this matter

02. As the plaintiff is currently abroad for an employment, the said Attorney is filing this case in this honorable court.

03 The above-mentioned Plaintiff and the defendant met upon a love relationship and got legally married on 17-07-2013, and the marriage certificate bearing No. 7068 related to that marriage is marked as 01 and is hereby submitted to the honorable court.

04. The Plaintiff states that both parties lived a happy married life around ten (10) years after the said marriage.

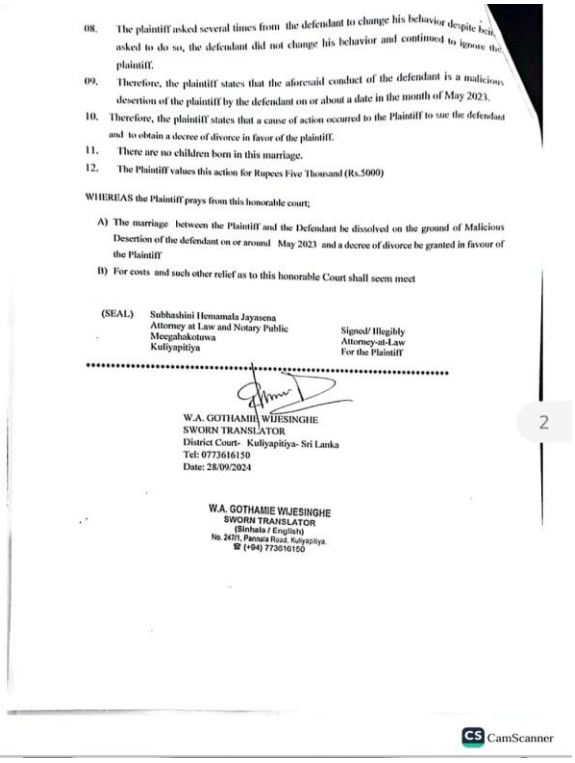
05 Later, while the Plaintiff was pregnant, the Defendant went to Cyprus on 04-02-2020 for an employment, with the consent of the Plaintiff. And the Plaintiff also went abroad on 21-10-2021. The plaintiff states that there was a miscarriage and later the plaintiff also went to the same country where the Defendant was working.

06. But, even after that both parties spent their marital life without any dispute. However, from the month of May 2023, the defendant's behavior gradually started to change. The plaintiff states that he ignored her stopped visiting the matrimonial house where the two parties were living together at that time.

07. While investigating this, the plaintiff came to know that the defendant was maintaining a relationship with another woman.

1

CamScanner



08. The plaintiff asked several times from the defendant to change his behavior despite being asked to do so, the defendant did not change his behavior and continued to ignore the plaintiff.

09. Therefore, the plaintiff states that the aforesaid conduct of the defendant is a malicious desertion of the plaintiff by the defendant on or about a date in the month of May 2023.

10. Therefore, the plaintiff states that a cause of action occurred to the Plaintiff to sue the defendant and to obtain a decree of divorce in favor of the plaintiff.

11. There are no children born in this marriage.

12. The Plaintiff values this action for Rupees Five Thousand (Rs.5000)

WHEREAS the Plaintiff prays from this honorable court;

A) The marriage between the Plaintiff and the Defendant be dissolved on the ground of Malicious Desertion of the defendant on or around May 2023 and a decree of divorce be granted in favour of the Plaintiff

B) For costs and such other relief as to this honorable Court shall seem meet

(SEAL) Subhashini Hemamala Jayasena
Attorney at Law and Notary Public
Meegahakotuwa
Kuliyapitiya

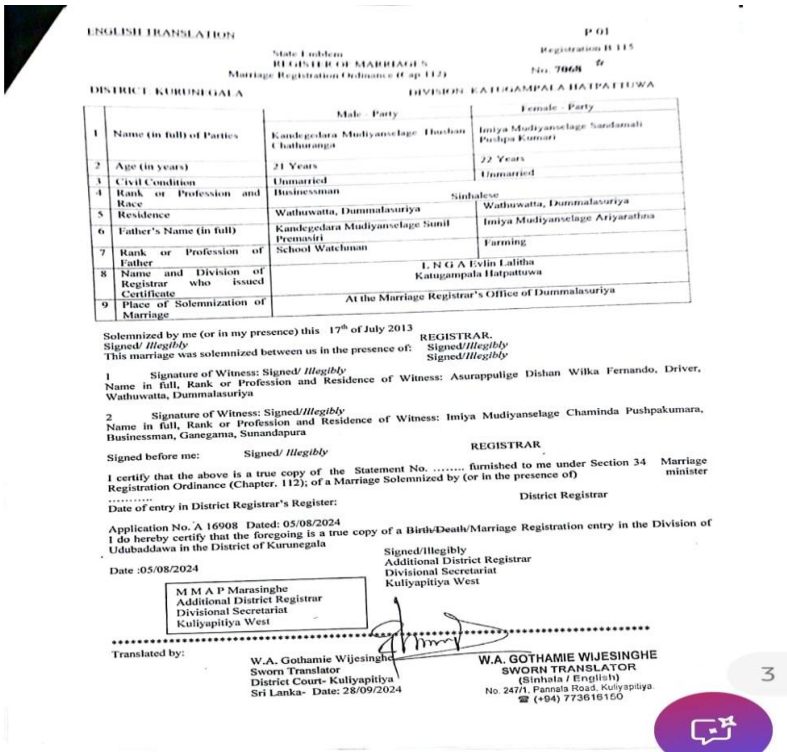
Signed/ Illegibly
Attorney-at-Law
For the Plaintiff

W.A. GOTHAMIE WIJESINGHE
SWORN TRANSLATOR
District Court- Kuliyapitiya- Sri Lanka
Tel: 0773616150
Date: 28/09/2024

W.A. GOTHAMIE WIJESINGHE
SWORN TRANSLATOR
(Sinhala / English)
No. 247/1, Pannara Road, Kuliyapitiya.
☎ (+94) 773616150

2

CamScanner



ENGLISH TRANSLATION

P 01

State Emblem
REGISTER OF MARRIAGES
Marriage Registration Ordinance (Cap 112)

Registration B 115
No. 7068

DISTRICT KURUNEGALA DIVISION KATUGAMPALA HATPATTUWA

		Male - Party	Female - Party
1	Name (in full) of Parties	Kandegedara Mudiyanselage Hashan Chathuranga	Imiya Mudiyanselage Sandamali Pushpa Kumari
2	Age (in years)	21 Years	22 Years
3	Civil Condition	Unmarried	Unmarried
4	Rank or Profession and Race	Businessman Sinhalese	
5	Residence	Wathuwatta, Dummalasuriya	Wathuwatta, Dummalasuriya
6	Father's Name (in full)	Kandegedara Mudiyanselage Sunil Premasiri	Imiya Mudiyanselage Ariyarathna
7	Rank or Profession of Father	School Watchman	Farming
8	Name and Division of Registrar who issued Certificate	L N G A Evlin Lalitha Katugampala Hatpattuwa	
9	Place of Solemnization of Marriage	At the Marriage Registrar's Office of Dummalasuriya	

Solemnized by me (or in my presence) this 17th of July 2013 REGISTRAR.
Signed/ *Illegibly* Signed/*Illegibly*
This marriage was solemnized between us in the presence of: Signed/*Illegibly*

1 Signature of Witness: Signed/ *Illegibly*
Name in full, Rank or Profession and Residence of Witness: Asurappulige Dishan Wilka Fernando, Driver, Wathuwatta, Dummalasuriya

2 Signature of Witness: Signed/*Illegibly*
Name in full, Rank or Profession and Residence of Witness: Imiya Mudiyanselage Chaminda Pushpakumara, Businessman, Ganegama, Sunandapura

Signed before me: Signed/ *Illegibly* REGISTRAR

I certify that the above is a true copy of the Statement No. …… furnished to me under Section 34 Marriage Registration Ordinance (Chapter. 112); of a Marriage Solemnized by (or in the presence of) minister
…… District Registrar
Date of entry in District Registrar's Register:

Application No. A 16908 Dated: 05/08/2024
I do hereby certify that the foregoing is a true copy of a ~~Birth/Death~~/Marriage Registration entry in the Division of Udubaddawa in the District of Kurunegala

Signed/Illegibly
Additional District Registrar
Divisional Secretariat
Kuliyapitiya West

Date :05/08/2024

M M A P Marasinghe
Additional District Registrar
Divisional Secretariat
Kuliyapitiya West

Translated by:

W.A. Gothamie Wijesinghe
Sworn Translator
District Court- Kuliyapitiya
Sri Lanka- Date: 28/09/2024

W.A. GOTHAMIE WIJESINGHE
SWORN TRANSLATOR
(Sinhala / English)
No. 247/1, Pannala Road, Kuliyapitiya.
☎ (+94) 773616150

3

CamScanner

Support materials for 15th July after 1st semester end assignment





